This is probably what most people think of when they think of Windows 8 since it is the hallmark addition

for Windows. WinRT apps can be written such that major parts of it will run on Windows phones, tablets and desktops with minor platform-specific code.

Windows 8 still supports running 16-bit applications made for Windows 1.0 (although you may have to enable this support), however only in the 32-bit version. Support for 16-bit applications has been absent in 64-bit versions of Windows since XP.

With WinRT now available, the clock has started ticking on Win32, which has been around since Windows 95. It's still a long way away, but eventually Win32 will go away, and it all starts with Windows 8.

Another major change that starts with Windows 8 has to do with a new storage architecture – we will cover that in more detail later – and even the beginning of the new ReFS file system that will eventually replace NTFS. And perhaps biggest of all, if certain rumours hold true is that Windows 8 will begin a trend of quicker Windows releases, with Windows 9, or some intermediate release of Windows coming in as early as next year.

Some Touching Improvements

While this may not be well known, Windows 7 was a multitouch capable OS, and even included a few multitouch-capable apps. For example, in MS Paint you could use multiple fingers to draw lines. Why this isn't well known is because Windows 7 was lacking one very important feature; it lacked a UI that can actually be used by touch.

Before we go on, it's important to know why touch is even important on a desktop OS. There are many people who will say touch is not a valu-